it’s a form of play and connection, a release from our everyday lives, and through it, it helps breed a new exuberance and a sense of youth and novelty to a game I have been entrenched in for decades.

We are beaten soundly in Australia and as Geoffrey Boycott quizzes me after the last game, asking who’s going to be responsible for this defeat, I tell him that it might be a question for someone above my pay grade and that I very much doubt I will be coming back to Australia as a 39-year-old, so maybe they should look to the future there. Everyone laughs. Even the idea of doing that, as a fast bowler, is laughable.